Reflection: LLM Output Evaluation

I set up my valuation notebook this way because I treat presets as tested, not adjusted on the spot. This important insight came about as a result of a failure—each run produced a 404 error because the model's name was invalid, so all ten responses were exactly 'Error '. The prompt claimed that all the responses had been successfully generated. The ROUGE-L score was 0.0, which meant the helpfulness metrics assessed the writing with no variation.

A score that lacks a sanity check may seem rigorous but, in reality, measures nothing at all. I also realized that my own custom 'summarization helpfulness' rating scale and persona templates were based on the assumption that the task in question was a summarization task, whereas the OpenOrca entries focus on QA, reasoning, and generation tasks. This mismatch would have biased the results even if the generation part had functioned.

For a team workflow, I would standardize six things:

- Before the flight, make a test call to verify the system can meet the request, and cancel the operation if an error occurs.
- Instead of a random sample of 10, use a dataset with 100 or more examples, each versioned and assigned to a specific task.
- Apply a range of predefined metrics, such as ROUGE, along with rubric-based metrics aligned to the task.
- For the joint experiment, record each run and note the prompt template, the model, and the parameters.
- Before settling on any general figure, carefully review the judges' explanations and draft a brief hypothesis for each prompt version so you can compare them deliberately.

In a professional environment, I would treat this as a quality check and update the prompt or model only when it improves beyond the standard level, using the same dataset and metrics. Whenever a new version of the model or writer is run, run the same tests again so the scheduled tests can catch any regressions in quality, latency, and cost before users do.